Getting Ready for the Planning Conversation About Mom

The family's part, in order, with a line for who does each and by when.

The goal: you can walk into the planning conversation and hand over a short, dated picture of Mom's care situation, her finances as you understand them, what you've learned about Medicaid so far, the papers you have, and your questions.

This is your family's part only, and it stops where the planning starts. The order is simply the one that makes the writing easier; it is not the order of the plan. Share the list, put a name and a day next to each action, and tick it when it's done.

ACTION	WHO	BY WHEN	DONE
1. Write a few lines on Mom's care situation today: where she is, the help she gets, and what the facility has told you.			
2. Write a few lines on her finances as you understand them: what comes in, what she owns, and what her care is costing each month. Round numbers are fine.			
3. Write down what you've learned or been told about Medicaid for Mom so far, with who said each thing.			
4. List the issues you've been told about, and mark each one “confirmed”, “assumed” or “don't know”. Don't judge them.			
5. List the documents you have, and the ones that still need to be collected.			
6. List the decisions in front of the family, in any order.			
7. Beside each decision, note whether you think it is the family's, an attorney's to review, or one for a licensed financial or insurance professional. “Not sure” is a fine answer.			
8. Write your questions down, including what to ask your Medicaid planner or an applications specialist about the timing of an application.			
9. Put a name beside each paper still to collect and each question still to ask.			
10. Go over all of it together as a family, so everyone has seen the same pages before the planning conversation.			

You're done when

Everyone in the family can say what you know, what is still open, which papers are missing and who is collecting each one, and your questions are written down with a name beside each. What happens next for Mom, who is responsible for it and in what order are what the planning conversation with your Medicaid planner is for. They aren't on this list, because they aren't the family's to settle alone.

If you get stuck

- Don't fill a gap by guessing. “We don't know yet” is a finished line.
- If two people were told different things, write both. Sorting them out isn't on this list.
- If a letter or a notice arrives that you don't understand, ask the office that sent it what it is asking for, and put it with the papers for your Medicaid planner.

What this plan doesn't do

It organizes your family's part. It doesn't say whether Mom is eligible for Medicaid, choose any legal or financial step, or stand in for the planning conversation it prepares you for. Nothing here is legal, tax or financial advice.

Ready for the next step?

You've put your family's part in order. The planning interview is where it goes next: it asks about Mom's situation and gives you a free planning report to carry into the planning conversation.

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